Bob has suggested a child arrangements plan

Bob used the Child Arrangements Plan service (https://propose-child-arrangements-plan.service.gov.uk/) on GOV.UK to suggest a plan for how you both might look after James, Rachel and Jack.

You can read their suggested plan and use it to collaborate to create child arrangements which you both agree on.

This plan is not legally binding and you do not have to do what it says.

If you don't agree, you can:

- use this form to suggest changes to Bob's proposed child arrangements plan
- start your own proposed child arrangements plan on GOV.UK or find a similar service
- make a written agreement of your own without using any service or template

Your safety

You should only respond to the suggested plan if:

- you're confident that you and your ex-partner can make decisions together without putting yourself or the children in danger
- you do not feel pressured or intimidated into responding

If you have any concerns about safety, stop now.

If you have any feedback or safety concerns about this service, you can email childarrangementssafety@justice.gov.uk.

We cannot answer any questions about child arrangement plans that have already been created.

How making a child arrangements plan can help

You may find that collaborating with Bob on a child arrangements plan:

- is cheaper and quicker than going to court (it usually takes around 10 months to get a court order, depending on where you live and whether it's urgent)
- leads to a better outcome for your children, which you and your ex-partner are in control of

Going to court can sometimes mean you are not the ones who make the final decisions about your child arrangements.

Tips to help you and your children

Your child arrangements plan should:

- put the child's welfare first
- reflect the wishes, feelings and needs of the child
- consider any harm the child has suffered or any risk of harm

If there is a court order in place

Do not continue if there's a court order in place relating to you, the other parent, or the children.

For example, a:

- child arrangements order
- specific issue order
- prohibited steps order
- protective order such as a non-molestation order, occupation order or a domestic abuse protection order
- any other order restricting contact between you and the other parent or the children

To change or enforce an existing child arrangements order, visit https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce/change-or-enforce-an-order.

Get more information

Use GOV.UK to find more information, for example:

- making child arrangements - https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce
- getting a legal separation - https://www.gov.uk/legal-separation
- getting a divorce - https://www.gov.uk/get-a-divorce

If you want legal advice

You can find a legal adviser: https://www.gov.uk/find-legal-advice/find-legal-adviser.

Getting help with domestic abuse

To find out more about signs and effects of child abuse and neglect, visit https://www.nspcc.org.uk/what-is-child-abuse.

If you're unsure whether you're a victim of domestic abuse, visit https://www.gov.uk/guidance/domestic-abuse-how-to-get-help#recognise-domestic-abuse.

This plan is not suitable for you if there has been:

- any form of domestic abuse or violence, even if the abuse was not directed at the children
- child abduction or attempted child abduction
- child abuse or neglect
- misuse of drugs, alcohol or other substances
- any other safety or welfare concerns that place anyone at significant risk of harm

Feedback and support

To ask for help using this service, or suggest improvements, you can email childarrangements@justice.gov.uk.

We cannot answer any questions about child arrangement plans that have already been created.

About this child arrangements proposal

Bob said:

- there is no court order in place at this time
- this is a proposed child arrangements plan for 3 children, James, Rachel and Jack
- this agreement is between Bob and Sam, who are the adults who will care for James, Rachel and Jack

Do you and Bob agree about the children's names, your names, and whether there is a court order in place?

Yes ☐ No ☐

We do not store these names or share any of this information with other government departments.

If you answered 'No', it may be helpful to find a mediator who can help you agree your child arrangements. You can get financial help with this. To find out more, go to https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce.

Living and visiting

Where will the children spend most of their time?

Bob suggested:
"test test test

test test test

If you do not agree, suggest where the children will spend most of their time

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the living and visiting section

Handovers and holidays

How will the children get between households?

Bob suggested:
"test test test

test test test

Where does handover take place?

It may be easier for children if the handover takes place at a neutral location which you're confident you'll both feel safe in.

Bob suggested that handover takes place at

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest where handover takes place

Will these arrangements change during school holidays?

Bob suggested that these arrangements should change during school holidays.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest whether the arrangements should change during the holidays

How will the arrangements be different in school holidays?

School holidays include half terms, bank holidays and inset days.

Bob suggested:
"test test test

test test test

test test test

test test test

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the handovers and holidays section

Special days

What will happen on special days?

Keep your children's needs and best interests at the centre of your plans for holidays and meaningful events. For example, New Year celebrations, Mother's Day and Father's Day, and birthdays.

Bob suggested:
"test test test

test test test

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the special days section

Other things

What other things matter to your children?

You may want to agree things such as:

- religious practices, diet, and standard rules across both households
- extra-curricular activities, such as swimming lessons
- access to other friends and family
- other types of contact, such as video calls

Bob suggested:
"test test test

test test test

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the other things section

Decision making

How should last-minute changes be communicated?

There will be times when plans will need to change, such as if one parent is suddenly unwell and cannot collect a child from school.

Bob suggested:
"test test test

test test test

How much notice should you give to change long-term arrangements?

Sometimes you may need to plan a long way ahead. For example, if you want to plan a holiday during time you do not usually spend with the children.

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest how much notice you should give each other

When will the children's needs change?

Children's needs change as they grow. When should you review this agreement to check it is still what's best for the children?

Bob suggested that you should review this arrangement in 1 month's time.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest when should you review this agreement

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the decision making section

What you need to do now

Now send this proposed child arrangements plan back to Bob. You should try to create a written record of what you have both agreed.

Any plan you make using this form is not legally binding. The other person does not have to do what it says and either of you can suggest changes to it at any time.

If you can't agree

If you are unable to reach agreement about your child arrangements, you can try mediation or another way of agreeing outside of court.

A mediator is a professional who will work with you to help you make decisions based on your child's best interests. They listen to both of you and take a neutral approach.

More information and support is available at https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce.

Get paid to give your feedback

With your help we can improve this service and understand how you use your plan.

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